Meeting Process

Meeting Agenda

- The agenda is an outline of what the meeting will address.
- Use descriptive headings, indicating what is to be discussed with each item.
- Ensure a logical flow from one item to the next.
- A review of the previous meeting's agenda can ensure continuity and follow up.
- The agenda should list the attendees, the meeting time and place, and the topics you plan to discuss

Purpose of Agenda

- ***Notice of meeting***
  - serves as a notice of meeting if it is sent out to meeting participants in advance.
- ***List of items/topics***
  - list of topics that will be discussed.
  - enables participants to prepare in advance for the topics so that they can make a more valuable contribution.
- ***Prioritise meeting discussion***
  - Topics that are of greatest importance should be placed first on the agenda.
  - In this way the agenda prioritise meeting discussion time.
- ***Briefs meeting participants***
  - If the agenda includes items with which are unfamiliar to the meeting's participants, the agenda item should be followed by some brief information as to what the item is about.

Meeting Minutes

- Accurate written (*official*) record of meetings.
- It is useful to have a written record of the meeting, what you've decided to do and who is going to do it.
- Minutes keep members of the group who weren't able to attend a meeting informed about what went on and remind people after some time if they forget.

Meeting Minutes

- Recording actions is easy. There are only three things you need to know:
  - **WHO**: has agreed to the action
  - **WHAT**: exactly have they agreed to do
  - **BY WHEN**: will they complete this
- Contains
  - name of the venue,
  - the date and time of the meeting,
  - and the list of all those who attended the meeting.
  - name of the person who takes these minutes.
- What should you write down?
  - Don't try to write everything down – it's impossible and not useful.
  - Concentrate on WHAT has been decided and WHO is going to do it. These are the most important things to have records of.

Summary!

- You will work on a project over the next 6 - 8 weeks
- Today is about **meetings** (not code):
  - Each group will use the set meeting process to create and allocate actions for the team members to work on.
  - The agenda has been set for you!
  - The meeting outcome are actions for your team to get done between now and the class.

What To Do today

1. Be clear about how to run the meeting (Some slides on that in a moment)
2. Organise the teams (3-4 people)
3. Decide who will be the “chair” person
4. Decide who will be the “minute” taker
5. Do the Meeting (and create “actions”)
6. If you have time, do some of the actions

Tips

Before and during the meeting:

- You will be ALLOCATING the ACTIONS to team members to do afterwards (after the meeting)
- Do NOT do the actions <u>during</u> the meeting - wait until after the meeting!

After the meeting:

- Aim to have any shared tools and details worked out before the class ends and people leave so that things can be done during the week

The Meeting Process!

Main Stages

- Before the Meeting
- At the Meeting
  - Start Meeting
  - Status Update (team level, team member level)
  - Pre-Agenda preparation
  - Process Agenda (create decisions and actions)
  - Post-Agenda
- After the Meeting

Before the Meeting

- Agenda should be set and shared
- Who can attend should be known
- Location, date and time should be known

Note:

- if there's no agenda, there's no meeting
- if people can't make it, there's no meeting
- if date/time/place are unknown, there's no meeting

At the Meeting

1. Start meeting,

2. Status update at ("information radiator”)
   - team level (done, doing, todo)
   - team member level (done, doing, todo, issues)

Note: there's not much to say for "status update" today (but there will be next week!), so move on …

Pre-Agenda

3. Prepare (pre-processing!)
   - The chair reads the agenda items so that everyone is aware of what will be used.
   - This is the last chance for anyone to fix/clarify, remove or add to the agenda

Note: There are NO changes to the agenda during the next step!

Process the Agenda

4. DO IT!
   - start the clock
   - for each item, in order,
     - make a decision, or
     - create and allocate an action [target date, people, outcome]
   - stop the clock

Post-Agenda

5. Is it Right? (post-processing!)
   - Each decision or action is read out loud to check for any issues.
   - Next meeting event planned and agreed

Extra Reminders/Notes:

- Read the Agenda
- Do NOT do actions in the meeting!
- The Chair and Minute taker must be different people. (It’s quicker!)
- People should volunteer to do actions.

After the Meeting

- Aim to have any shared tools and details worked out before the class ends and people leave so that things can be done during the week